

ingrained habits.

As a thought experiment, imagine what would happen if you purposefully inverted this idea—what if you tried to assemble a how-to list in pursuit of the exact opposite—getting *more noise* and *less signal*? In other words, what are exactly the *wrong* things to do as a media-consuming investor?

Warning: You may recognize yourself in a few of these.

How to get more noise and less signal

1. **Constantly consume mainstream media.** Financial television is an excellent source of actionable trading ideas.
2. **Play down data.** It's overrated. Stick with anecdotes and your own gut instincts.
3. **Pay attention to pundits.** They exist for the sole purpose of helping you reach a comfortable retirement.
4. **Get the inside dope.** All important information about the stock market—especially when it is going to crash or rally—is known only to a handful of secret insiders. Buy the newsletters that promise to share this inside info!
5. **Stress about *this*.** Exert lots of energy, spend lots of time, create lots of tension about the following: Federal Reserve and rates, AI, dollar versus euro, Gaza, Congress, Nvidia, hyperinflation, Ukraine, Tesla, European Sovereign Bank debt, gold, China, deflation, Bitcoin, commodities, and the Hindenburg Omen.
6. **Don't do the math.** Numbers are vastly overrated, and probability analysis is for geeks anyway.
7. **Stay in your bubble.** Focus only on those news sources that are in sync with your politics. Seek out sources that confirm your pre-existing opinions and investment postures. Never read anything that challenges your beliefs.